



The 1980s

Flying became a standard mode of travel for many in the developed world in the 1980s, creating a fiercely competitive market for passenger airliners, with a focus on comfort and size. Jets became increasingly powerful, but quieter and more fuel-efficient than ever before. The small helicopter market grew almost entirely thanks to the introduction of the cheap and simple-to-operate Robinson R22. The military developed stealth planes, which were practically invisible to conventional radar tracking systems.